JAMES EDWARD HARRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Principal Engineer with 12 years of hands-on expertise in designing and delivering large-scale distributed systems across financial services and media sectors. Known for mentoring engineering teams, establishing best practices, and leading technical architecture decisions that have directly improved system reliability and reduced operational costs. Based in Leeds, I've spent the last decade building resilient infrastructure while helping junior engineers develop their technical craft.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

Vertex Systems Ltd

vertexsystems.io

Leeds, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led the architecture and implementation of microservices platform serving 2.5 million daily active users with 99.99% uptime SLA

Established comprehensive monitoring and observability strategy using Prometheus and ELK stack, reducing mean time to resolution by 40%

Mentored team of 8 engineers on cloud-native principles and code review practices, resulting in three internal promotions

Designed and implemented automated CI/CD pipeline reducing deployment time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes

Lead Systems Architect

Quantum Innovations Group

quantuminnovations.co

Manchester, United Kingdom

September 2017 - February 2021

Architected real-time analytics platform processing 500 million events daily using Apache Kafka and PostgreSQL

Implemented comprehensive disaster recovery procedures and achieved RPO of 15 minutes across all critical systems

Led migration of legacy monolithic application to containerized microservices, improving deployment frequency from monthly to daily releases

Conducted technical interviews and hired 12 engineers, establishing new hiring criteria that improved team retention by 35%

Senior Software Engineer

Accenture

accenture.com

Leeds, United Kingdom

June 2012 - August 2017

Developed high-frequency trading systems for tier-one investment bank using Java and C++, handling transaction volumes exceeding 100,000 trades per day

Implemented LangChain-based solutions for real-time market data processing and predictive analytics

Designed and deployed PostgreSQL database infrastructure supporting 50+ mission-critical applications with replication across three geographic regions

Collaborated with enterprise architects to establish security standards and compliance frameworks meeting FCA regulatory requirements

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science

University of Sheffield

Sheffield, United Kingdom

2009 - 2011

BSc Software Engineering

University of Leeds

Leeds, United Kingdom

2005 - 2009

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Go, SQL, Bash

Cloud Platforms: AWS, GCP, Azure

Containerization: Docker, Docker Swarm

Orchestration: Kubernetes, Terraform, ArgoCD

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, DynamoDB

Messaging: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Infrastructure: Linux, Nginx, HAProxy

Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack

Version Control: Git, GitLab, Bitbucket

Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Kanban